Frah Ali Aman

Accessibility Strategy & Systems Advisor

Senior Accessibility Auditor & Tester · WCAG 2.1/2.2 · Web, Web Apps, iOS & Android

Focus: Digital transformation, accessibility governance, enterprise/public sector audits, and cross-functional enablement to reduce risk and improve user experience.

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Summary

Digital accessibility strategist and senior auditor/tester with hands-on experience evaluating websites, web applications, and native mobile apps against WCAG 2.1 and 2.2. I translate accessibility standards into scalable, developer-ready guidance—including audits, remediation prioritization, and QA retesting—enabling teams to reduce risk and ship accessible digital experiences across enterprise and public-sector environments.

Core skills

- **Standards:** Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.1 and 2.2, Accessible Rich Internet Applications (WAI-ARIA), Section 508, European Standard EN 301 549, Voluntary Product Accessibility Template (VPAT), and Accessibility Conformance Report (ACR)
- **Testing:** Manual keyboard testing, focus management, name/role/value checks, status messages, reflow and zoom, color contrast, motion and reduced motion, and target size
- **Assistive technologies:** NVDA, JAWS, VoiceOver on iOS and macOS, TalkBack on Android

- **Tooling:** axe DevTools, Lighthouse, Pa11y, WAVE, Android Accessibility Scanner, iOS Accessibility Inspector, Chrome DevTools, and Firefox DevTools
- **Development literacy:** HTML5, CSS3, semantic patterns, JavaScript, and Document Object Model inspection
- **Design collaboration:** Figma annotations to surface issues early and reduce rework
- **AI-assisted workflows:** Prompt design, evaluation, and human-in-the-loop review for accessibility triage
- **Stakeholder engagement:** Executive briefings, cross-functional walkthroughs, workshops, and trainings
- **Consulting:** Risk framing, roadmap guidance, change enablement, and procurement support (VPAT/ACR)
- **Cloud:** Microsoft Azure

Professional Experience

Consultant, Digital Accessibility & Design, BDO Canada

March 2026 to Present — Toronto, Ontario

- Lead accessibility audits and provide strategic remediation guidance aligned with WCAG 2.1 and 2.2 across enterprise client engagements
- Contribute to proposal development and client-facing materials, supporting business development and accessibility-focused engagements
- Develop structured accessibility work plans and remediation roadmaps tailored to client systems, timelines, and compliance goals
- Create accessibility program plans to guide organizations toward long-term inclusive design and regulatory alignment
- Design and develop e-learning content to support accessibility training, awareness, and internal capability building
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams including design, development, product, and leadership to integrate accessibility into delivery workflows

Accessibility Specialist and Consultant, Digita11y Accessible

February 2023 to 2025 — Remote, Toronto, Ontario

- Led end-to-end WCAG 2.1 and 2.2 accessibility audits across web, mobile, and SaaS platforms for finance, insurance, and government clients; reduced major violations by up to 80% in targeted remediation sprints

- Delivered executive-ready briefings and cross-functional walkthroughs across design, engineering, and QA, aligning teams on accessibility risk, remediation priorities, and release readiness
- Guided remediation through Jira using annotated findings, code-level recommendations, and QA retesting to support sustainable compliance improvements
- Supported **VPAT/ACR** documentation and procurement readiness, translating audit outcomes into defensible evidence for stakeholders across North America and the Gulf region
- Provided ongoing enablement through checklists, Figma annotations, and office hours to embed accessibility across the product lifecycle
- **AI-assisted triage (pilot):** Accelerated initial assessment workflows by leveraging LLMs to pre-draft WCAG mappings and audit summaries under human review

Web Accessibility Consultant (Freelance), Softsim Technologies

October 2022 to January 2023 — Remote, Montreal, Quebec

- Conducted software and document accessibility audits and produced reports aligned to the Website Accessibility Conformance Evaluation Methodology
- Delivered quality assurance assessments and remediation recommendations written for development teams

Accessibility Engineer and User Experience Designer, Allyant (Accessible360)

September 2021 to June 2022 — Remote, Ottawa, Ontario

- Performed in-depth audits and provided remediation strategies for enterprise websites and applications
- Translated research into actionable user journey maps and design recommendations

Web and User Interface Designer, DMS with Invest Ottawa

January 2021 to March 2021 — Ottawa, Ontario

- Led user research and delivered responsive user interfaces with semantic HTML and CSS that improved usability and search engine optimization
- Collaborated with developers to resolve defects and improve site performance

Web and User Interface Designer, Innovative Ventures / Qabso Project

October 2019 to Present — Remote, San Francisco, California

- Design and evolve mobile and desktop interfaces for the Qabso application in collaboration with distributed stakeholders

Graphic, Web, and User Interface Designer, Frah Designer

September 2011 to Present — Remote

- Designed accessible, user-friendly concepts, wireframes, and interactive prototypes for clients and facilitated design-thinking workshops

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Selected work highlights

- **Focus management in dialogs:** Identified focus escaping modals. Proposed a JavaScript focus trap and returning focus to the trigger. Validated with NVDA. Result: improved task completion.
- **Status messages:** Added live region announcements for timers and alerts using polite updates. Verified on JAWS and NVDA. Result: critical alerts are announced without stealing focus.
- **Pre-development checks in Figma:** Added roles, accessible names, focus order, and color contrast checks to frames. Result: reduced rework during quality assurance.
- **AI-assisted accessibility triage:** Introduced LLM-drafted JIRA defects with WCAG references under human review, speeding batch triage and improving consistency of guidance to developers.

Education and training

- Deque University, WCAG Pre-certifications — 2022
- Google User Experience Foundation Design Certificate (Coursera) — 2021
- Interactive Media Design Diploma, Algonquin College, Ottawa — 2019

Tools and technologies

- **Languages:** HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, PHP, French.
- **Frameworks and content systems:** React, Vue, Node.js, WordPress, Drupal, Bootstrap, Tailwind.
- **Design and assistive technology:** Figma, Sketch, InVision, NVDA, JAWS, VoiceOver.
- **Other:** Git, Representational State Transfer Application Programming Interfaces, quality assurance testing, accessibility auditing and compliance.

- **Cloud:** Microsoft Azure

Volunteer work

- Co-Director, Social Media & External Communications, Women in Communications & Technology (WCT), National Capital Region (NCR) — June 2025–Present
- Member, IAAP — Present
- Secretary, Board of Directors, Carpenter Housing Co-op — July 2023–2024
- Accessibility Consultant, Al Nuura Charity — 2021-2022
- Graphic Designer Lead, Fankeenna — 2021 to 2023
- User Interface Designer, Random Hacks of Kindness — 2018

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